CONSUMING FIRE
MINISTRIES INTERNATIONAL

OLD HIGHFIELD ASSEMBLY (HARARE)

CFMI MUSIC MINISTRY

© JULY 2017

"Let everything that has breath praise the Lord. Praise the Lord." (Psalms 150:6)

Introduction

The focus of music is not to "showcase" our talents, but to minister to the Lord and to offer our music for Him to use in any way the He sees fit. The music team will perform songs that are Bible-based and indicative of worship, praise and ministry of the Gospel. Songs with obvious overtures to secular music, or questionable lyrics will not be utilized. Praise is primarily the expression of admiration and approval. It includes the expression of gratitude and thanksgiving for what God has done. We are not only to praise God but to worship Him. Worship of God is the extolling of the Person, character, attributes and perfection of God. God is worshipped for who He is and not for anything we have benefited from Him. The Bible emphasizes that we should sing spiritual songs, psalms and hymns to praise and worship God. CFMI values the importance of true praise and worship. Christians should celebrate and adore God through words and music. Christians should praise God for who He is, for His goodness, for His mighty acts, for His mercy and all His blessings. God inhabits the praises of His people (Psalm 22:3). The main purpose for music in the Church is to share the Gospel of Jesus Christ through song and praise, to lead the congregation in worship and praise, to provide an avenue for believers to share their spiritual gifts and be an integral part of the worship experience and edify believers as they celebrate and express the joy of their salvation.

Guidelines for New Members who want to join the Music Team

a) Membership is open to **anyone who is 16 years of age or older who regularly attends CFMI Church and is in agreement with the goals and objectives of the church body**.
b) **Must be saved, and a member (and regular attender) of CFMI**.
c) Must accept and abide by the Biblical guidelines, as presented by the Pastor of the assembly.
d) **Must spend time in prayer and regular Bible study, seeking to maintain a close relationship with Jesus Christ and empowerment of the Holy Ghost**. Christian living is more important than ministry and service.
e) Every member must be loyal to the Pastor, staff, and church body and must be willing to work in harmony with other church leaders and members.
f) All members **must be an example of worship in public and private life**.
g) All new members of the music team shall be required to undergo **a Probation Period of 4 weeks**.
h) During this period, the new member shall be expected to come for all music team meetings– both music practice and prayer meetings.
i) During this period, the new member shall not be ministering with the music team in the services but shall be under assessment.
j) The new member is expected to learn the regular songs that are performed in the Church in order to effectively participate in the music team.
k) The conduct of the new member during the probation period will greatly determine if the member will be formally admitted into the music team or will have to undergo further probation or to be dropped.
l) Every member must sing for the edification of the church body to the glory and praise of God.
m) Members are expected to refrain from chewing gum, eating candy, passing notes, texting, phone conversations and unnecessary talking during rehearsals and services/performances.
n) Every member must have an open mind about the music selection and develop a spirit of serving and must maintain a positive attitude about your position of ministry.
o) Every member must seek to resolve conflict with others in a Biblical manner.

Music Team Leadership

The music team leaders are appointed by the Church leadership. Their terms of office shall be for **one year**, upon which the leadership will **re-appoint or change the current leaders**. The music team shall have two offices and the Church leadership reserves the right to add more offices as the need arise.

Praise Leader

Shall be responsible for compiling praise songs teaching other singers and leading the Church in praise songs to God during all services. The assigned praise leader is expected to have prayerfully selected and arranged the songs well ahead of time.

Worship Leader

Shall be responsible for compiling praise songs teaching other singers and leading the Church in worship songs to God during all services. The assigned worship leader is expected to have prayerfully selected and arranged the songs well ahead of time. If there are any new songs, the praise/worship leader is expected to inform all back-up singers before the practice day.

Instrumentalists

Instrumentalists are expected to be available to play music instruments at all practice and service times. The assigned praise/worship leaders are expected to meet/discuss with the instrumentalists to work together on the song selection and arrangement before the time allotted for general music practice.

Music Practice Time Schedule

In order to ensure adequate respect for everyone's time the music team practice will have the following recommended schedule:

	ACTIVITY	**DURATION**
1	Prayers and Worship Music Development Moment	**30mins**
2	Vocals Practice	**30mins**
3	Praise Songs Practice (3 Songs)	**30mins**
4	Worship Songs Practice (3 Songs)	**30mins**
5	Songs for Giving Time and Intercession Time Practice (4 Songs)	**30mins**
6	Special Song/New song Rehearsals	**30mins**
7	Closing Prayers	**1min**
	TOTAL	**3 Hours**

The official time for Music Practice will be from 12pm -3pm, however if any changes should be made, notification should be made prior to music practice to accommodate changes and to respect other people's time.

Conduct for practice sessions

The Music Team shall meet at least once every week (or as decided by the team leaders) to effectively rehearse for ministrations. At each of these meetings, the following is expected from each member:

a.) Even the most dedicated music team member may sometimes not be able to attend rehearsal or service due to circumstances beyond their control. Any member who will not be available for practice should have informed the music team leadership before the time for practice. For music team members, if you are going to be absent on Sunday you should still attend the Saturday practice session. We are constantly learning new music and it is not always just for the Sunday service immediately following the Saturday rehearsal.
b.) All music team members should endeavour not to miss more than 2 music practice meetings in a month.
c.) The first 30 minutes of the Music practice shall be devoted to prayers /worship. Any music team member who misses this period without informing others shall not be allowed to minister with the music team on the next Service day.
d.) All music team members are expected to be punctual and regular for midweek services to assist with backing-up.
e.) A high level of discipline is expected during practice – minimal side talks and distractions. Cell phones should be switched off or put on silent during practice sessions.
f.) The time schedule put up for music practice is to be strictly followed.
g.) Those team members who consistently absent themselves from practice sessions and church meetings without notice will be asked to sit down until they can become dedicated to serve in the Church.
h.) All music team members are expected to come for practice with their notebooks and pen and sit according to their parts (for vocalists) and their roles (for instrumentalists).
i.) All music team members are expected to give and receive correction in love.

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Dressing and Presentation

A roster specifying the colour codes for the services should be prepared on a quarterly basis. All music team members are expected to fully comply with the colour codes at all times. The colour code for any particular Service may be changed at the discretion of the Music Team Leadership. Wherever possible the team should dress to match the decorations in the Church and theme of the services. All members shall be require to put on ministerial uniforms approved by the Church leadership. Every member will be required to sacrifice their own money to buy at least one set of uniform in order to be presentable. If required for special occasions, the church will provide choir uniforms for all music team members. All music team members are required to dress modestly, decently, appropriately to look presentable and acceptable on all occasions and during all Church Services. Any member who shall be found not abiding by this code, shall be asked to sit down and not minister until corrections are made. Indecent dressing, excessive make-up, wearing sexy clothes, tight fitting clothes, mini-skirts, blouses that reveal cleavage, see-throughs and tight jeans or trousers for women will not be acceptable during ministrations and any other church meetings.

Conduct during Church Service

All music team members that have attended rehearsals are expected to be present for the relevant Church Service. During the Service, the following is expected of all music team members –including instrumentalists:

a) Warm-up before the Sunday Service is crucial to our ministry effectiveness. It is important to arrive at least 15-30mins before the Church starts to warm-up voices and rehearse music, perform necessary sound checks and then prepare for ministry.
b) Fully comply with the agreed choir dress code

c) Punctually attend the ministerial prayers before and after the services where applicable.
d) Be seated according to their parts/ roles before the start of the Service.
e) Actively participate in the Service – prayers, bible reading, prayer, sermon etc. – the music team members are serving like ministers in the church and should display the accorded level of discipline and responsibility.
f) Keep to what was agreed during the rehearsals; except where otherwise approved by the music team leadership.
g) Be ready to immediately back up impromptu songs raised during the course of the Service.
h) Singers assigned to leading/ backing-up songs on the microphone are expected to keep this as their primarily responsibility for the Service.
i) Please refrain from any and all unnecessary movement and talking while in the praise and worship. Talking and moving can be picked up by the microphone and the video camera and many times is heard throughout the congregation.

When Singing:

Avoid spitting on the microphone.
Avoid holding the microphone far away from your mouth such that your voice cannot come out properly.
Avoid dropping the microphone.
Avoid bringing the microphone too close to your mouth.
Avoid covering the place where the microphone is supposed to receive the voice with your hands.
Avoid dancing on the cables or stepping on the cables.
Hold the microphone properly.

Seven biblical reasons why singing matters:

1. When you sing you obey God's command - Col 3:16, Eph 5:18-19.
2. When you sing you dig deep roots in the word - Col 2:16.
3. When you sing you build up others - Eph 5:18-19.
4. When you sing you make war - Eph 5:16.
5. When you sing you are spiritually strengthened for trials - Acts 16:25.
6. When you sing you walk a God designed pathway to joy - Psalm 5:11, 59:16.
7. When you sing you glorify God - Rev 7:9-10.

Singing has such a unique way of bringing your heart, soul, mind, and strength together to focus entirely and completely on God.

CFMI Leadership reserves the right to add or remove members of the music team, teach, rebuke or discipline any of the members in the team who do not abide by the terms and conditions in this document.

After the Music Team Training is completed and copies are given to each team member, a copy of a signed document shall be kept by the Church.

Date of Training: _____/_____/_____ Name(s) of Trainer(s): _____ _____

_____ _____ _____ _____

Pastor **Music Team Leaders** **Church Secretary**